



EVER SATURDAY, UNTIL YOU DIE

HATE MOWING YOUR LAWN?

- ☐ Your gut is correct
- ☐ The actual reason lawns exist
- ☐ What 40M acres of grass costs you
- ☐ What grows instead, and how to get there
- ☐ Lawn fertilizer tips
- ☐ Any reason to keep mowing

SKU
LAWN-ABOLITION-001

EDITION
First

COVERAGE
Your whole block

ACTIVE INGREDIENT
Class consciousness

For best results, share with neighbors. May cause disagreements with HOA boards. Not responsible for policy changes. Keep away from turf industry lobbyists. Propagate freely.



ABOLISH-LAWNS.ORG

YOUR GUT IS CORRECT.

You are not lazy. You are not a bad neighbor. You have been mowing because it is legally required and costly to stop.

The American lawn covers 40 million acres — more than any food crop. We spend \$153 billion a year on it. 9 billion gallons of water a day. Half that water evaporates before reaching the roots.

Lawns produce nothing edible, support almost no insect life, and receive more pesticide per acre than any agricultural crop. The runoff poisons local waterways. This is not a side effect. It is what lawns do.

"We don't really believe in mowing the lawn; we do it only to avoid unnecessary engagement with the neighbors."

— Miranda July, *No One Belongs Here More Than You* (2007)

Hundreds of municipalities classify vegetation above 8–12 inches as a 'public health menace.' 78 million Americans live under HOA covenants specifying lawn standards and fining noncompliance. These rules run with the land. They do not expire.

You were right to hate it.

YOU'RE NOT ALONE.

The lawn care industry spends heavily to make dissent feel eccentric. It isn't. Here are three people who said the quiet part out loud.

"I hate mowing the lawn. Hate it. My body goes on autopilot while my brain tries to figure a way out of ever doing this again. I am Sisyphus."

— Hatch Magazine reader, hatchmag.com

"Their spirits were probably broken ten years ago."

— thelawnforum.com — on neighbors who stopped caring

"I hate mowing the lawn. I hate the idea of wasting resources on something as stupid and superficial as grass, but I have an HOA."

— Quora, question on HOA lawn standards



WHAT PRODUCTIVE LAND LOOKS LIKE.

WHAT WOULD BE BETTER.

☐ NATIVE MEADOW

Once-a-year mow. 10–100x more insect life. No irrigation. Requires repealing your local weed ordinance.

☐ FRONT-YARD FOOD

Prohibited by HOA in most planned communities, illegal by zoning in many cities. Produces food. This is the correct use of your land.

☐ COMMUNITY FOOD FOREST

Shared harvests. Requires a commons, not a HOA.

☐ BIOSWALE

Reduces flooding. Saves the city money. Often eligible for a rebate your city won't advertise.

☐ NOTHING

Let it return to local ecology. Illegal in most of America. That fact is the argument.

WHAT WE'RE DOING. HOW TO JOIN. WHY IT MATTERS.



This land could be productive. It isn't, because it's a lawn.

Abolish Lawns shifts public opinion, gives owners a gradient of actions, and provides the policy language for reform at scale. Opinion first. Policy follows.

SHIFT OPINION

Zines and factsheets for people who already know the lawn is wrong.

SUPPORT OWNERS

From 'stop watering' to 'challenge your HOA covenant in court.'

CHANGE POLICY

Model ordinances and legislative language for planners who want to act.

JOIN US.

- Read the manifesto: jason-edelman.org/abolish-lawns
- Follow @abolish.lawns on Instagram
- Print this. Leave it somewhere. Print more.
- Stop watering. See what happens.
- Show up to your next city council meeting.

PRINT THIS. SHARE IT. PROPAGATE FREELY.

jason-edelman.org/abolish-lawns

commons framework: power-explained.jason-edelman.org